1. (d) (II) and (IV)
2. (a) Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A).
3. (c) (A)-(IV), (B)-(III), (C)-(II), (D)-(I)
4. (a) Concentration of power under one centre undermines the concept of democracy.
5. (b) USA, Switzerland, Australia
6. (c) (A)-(IV), (B)-(III), (C)-(II), (D)-(I)
7. (b) Both (A) and (R) are true but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A).
8. (a) social stereotypes cannot be eliminated by development alone.
9. (b) Casteism
10. (d) Statements (III) and (IV) only
11. (b) Patriarchy
12. (d) (A) is false but (R) is true.
13. (c) Statements (I) and (II) only
14. (b) State Party
15. (a) Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A).
16. In Sri Lanka, an Act was passed in 1956 to recognise Sinhala as the only official language, disregarding Tamil.
17. Belgium is a small country in Europe and shares borders with France, the Netherlands, Germany, and Luxembourg.
18. Lack of legally imposed quotas or reservation policy at central level.
19. India is a secular country.
20. The Mayor
21. The Union Government (Central Government)

22.

- **Evolves Over Time:** A party system cannot be chosen overnight; it develops slowly based on a country's social divisions, political history, and election system.
- **Depends on Circumstances:** Every country develops its own party system suited directly to its unique domestic situations.
- **Reflects Diversity:** In large and diverse countries like India, a multi-party system evolved because the immense social and geographical diversity cannot be represented by just two or three parties.

23.

- **Three Levels of Government:** The Constitution provides for a multi-tier governance model—the Union Government, State Governments, and local bodies (Panchayats and Municipalities), each having its own jurisdiction.
- **Three Legislative Lists:** Powers are clearly divided between the Centre and States across three distinct lists: the Union List, State List, and Concurrent List.
- **Independent Judiciary:** In case of any dispute between the Centre and the States regarding the division of powers, the Supreme Court and High Courts act as an umpire to settle constitutional conflicts.

24.

- **Against Secularism:** India is a secular nation where all religions are treated equally by law, so asking for votes on religious grounds goes directly against the Constitution.
- **Divides Society:** Appealing to religious sentiments fosters communalism and divides

citizens into conflicting groups, harming social harmony.

- **Violates Election Rules:** According to election laws and the Model Code of Conduct, seeking votes using religion or caste is strictly an illegal and corrupt practice.
- **Distracts from Real Issues:** It shifts public focus away from essential matters like jobs, education, and development toward emotional and communal debates.